

Rghost

Quick manual — copy → R → text/plot

v0.3.3 · 2026

A sniper, not a Swiss army knife. No editor; clipboard + local R.

1 30-second start

1. Unzip so `rghost.exe` and `rghost_rhost.exe` stay together.
2. Run `rghost.exe` (toolbar, top-right).
3. Click **Idle** → **Armed** (amber).
4. In another app, select R code and copy (**Ctrl+C**).
5. See results in **Console** / **Plot**.

2 Traffic lights

- **Set** — preferences (opacity, R, hotkeys, SynEdit, plot).
- **Idle/Armed** — clipboard sniper on/off.
- **Kill** — stop *this app's* R engine (see below).
- **Panel** — show/hide the output window.
- **Clear** — clear console and plot.

Rghost icon: menu *Help / About / Quit* (click the icon). Drag the bar by the background or the name.

3 Rterm.exe vs R.dll

Under **Set** → **R session** → **Use**:

- **Rterm.exe** (default) — pipes to a child `Rterm.exe`.
- **R.dll** — embedded R via sidecar `rghost_rhost.exe`. The GUI never loads `R.dll`; only the sidecar does, so an R crash need not take down Rghost.
- Choose **R home** (empty = newest R on this PC).
- Status bar badge: e.g. `R.dll · 4.5.0` or `Rterm.exe · devel` (or `R: idle`).

For **R.dll**, keep `rghost_rhost.exe` beside `rghost.exe`.

4 Kill

- Ends only Rghost's current child — `Rterm.exe` or `rghost_rhost.exe` — not RStudio or unrelated R processes.
- Works mid-eval (hard terminate). Toolbar returns to green **Idle**; click **Arm** for a fresh session.
- Changing R home / Use while running kills the old session first.

5 Clipboard and dedup

When **Armed**, eval runs only if clipboard *text* changes. Copying the same selection again does **not** re-run (feature, not a bug). To repeat: change one character, or use a dedicated Capture hotkey.

Operational notices go to the console meta stream; the status bar shows the engine badge and short tips.

6 Panel

- **Console** — read-only SynEdit; Ctrl+Tab switches tabs.
- After eval, focus is **Auto** by default: **Plot** if this eval drew graphics, else **Console** (Set → Plot panel to force Console or Plot).
- **Plot** — high-res PNG; zoom, history ←/→, optional PDF.
- Bookmarks (if enabled): Ctrl+Shift+0..9 / Ctrl+0..9.

7 Settings

- **Appearance** — opacity, toolbar orientation, theme.
- **R session** — R home, Browse, Use {Rterm.exe | R.dll}.
- **Hotkey** — Capture and Arm chords.
- **Editor** — font, highlighter, view options.
- **Plot panel** — history, PDF, after-eval focus.

8 Hotkeys (defaults)

- **Ctrl+Alt+R** — Arm / Idle.
- **Ctrl+C** — Capture via system clipboard (when Armed).

Configurable under **Set** → **Hotkey**.

9 R and config

Prefs JSON: %LOCALAPPDATA%\Rghost/rghost.json.

10 Troubleshooting

- No output — **Armed**? New clipboard text? Badge not R: idle?
- No plot — this chunk must draw (plot, abline, ...).
- R.dll won't start — is rghost_rhost.exe next to the app? Is R.dll under R home? Or switch Use to Rterm.exe.
- Stuck eval — press **Kill**, then Arm again.